JIM JORDAN, Ohio
CHAIRMAN

JERROLD NADLER, New York
RANKING MEMBER

ONE HUNDRED EIGHTEENTH CONGRESS

Congress of the United States
House of Representatives
COMMITTEE ON THE JUDICIARY
2138 RAYBURN HOUSE OFFICE BUILDING
WASHINGTON, DC 20515–6216
(202) 225–6906
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June 7, 2023

Mr. Bradley Benavides
Senior Risk Manager
Amazon
410 Terry Avenue N
Seattle, Washington 98109

Dear Mr. Benavides:

The Committee on the Judiciary is continuing to investigate allegations of misconduct at the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI). You served as Section Chief and then Deputy Assistant Director for the FBI's Counterintelligence Division from July 2019 until July 2022. We believe that you possess unique information vital to our oversight. Accordingly, we ask that you make yourself available for a transcribed interview with Committee staff.

On August 6, 2020, you provided a briefing to Senators Chuck Grassley and Ron Johnson that hampered their investigation into Hunter Biden's financial connections to foreign governments and questionable foreign nationals.[1] As the Senators subsequently stated in a letter to you:

> [T]he unnecessary FBI briefing provided the Democrats and liberal media the vehicle to spread their false narrative that our work advanced Russian disinformation. Although you stated that the FBI didn't intend to "interfere" in our investigation, the practical effect of such an unnecessary briefing and the subsequent leaks relating to it created interference, which frustrated and obstructed congressional oversight efforts.[2]

[1] Letter from Ranking Member Charles E. Grassley, S. Comm. on Judiciary, and Ranking Member Ron Johnson, S. Perm. Subcomm. on Investigations, to Ms. Nikki Floris, Intel. Analyst in Charge, Intel. Div., FBI, and Mr. Bradley Benavides, Deputy Assistant Dir., Counterintel. Div., FBI (Aug. 25, 2022).
[2] *Id.*

Senator Grassley elaborated in testimony before the Select Subcommittee on the Weaponization of the Federal Government earlier this year.[3] He explained: "the briefing was unnecessary and completely irrelevant to the substance of our investigation. It was only done because the Democrats wanted it done so they could try and smear us. And the FBI wrongly did their bidding."[4]

The allegations that the FBI arranged a briefing for two United States senators as a pretext to impede their investigation—and then leaked that briefing to the media—are deeply troubling. We, therefore, ask that you make yourself available for a transcribed interview with Committee staff.

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The Committee on the Judiciary has legislative and oversight jurisdiction over the FBI pursuant to Rule X of the Rules of the House of Representatives.[5] To schedule your transcribed interview, please contact Committee staff at (202) 225-6906 as soon as possible, but no later than 5:00 p.m. on June 21, 2023. If you are represented by counsel, please ask your attorney to contact Committee staff on your behalf.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this matter.

Sincerely,

Jim Jordan
Chairman

cc: The Honorable Jerrold L. Nadler, Ranking Member

[3] *Hearing on the Weaponization of the Federal Government: Hearing before the Subcomm. on the Weaponization of the Fed. Gov't of the H. Comm. on the Judiciary*, 118th Cong. (2023).
[4] *Id.*
[5] Rules of the U.S. House of Representatives, R. X (2023).